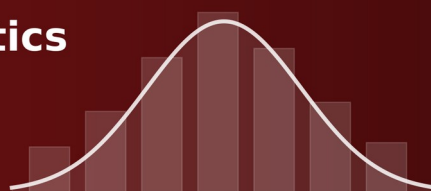


ECON 2843 · Elements of Statistics

Business Statistics

Fall 2026 · Section 004 · Tue & Thu 4:30-5:45 p.m. · Cate Center One 0237



COURSE AT A GLANCE

Course	ECON 2843-004 · Elements of Statistics (Business Statistics)
CRN / Credits	52298 · 3 credit hours
Term	August 24 – December 11, 2026
Meeting time	Tuesdays & Thursdays, 4:30 – 5:45 p.m. (in person)
Location	Cate Center One, Room 0237
Final exam	Monday, December 14, 2026 · 4:30 – 6:30 p.m. · Cate Center One 0237
Instructor	Mahla Shourian
Email	mahla.shourian@ou.edu
Office hours	Best to catch me before/after class; otherwise email to set a time (in person or Zoom)
Prerequisite	ALEKS math assessment 040+, or MATH 1523+, or completion of MATH 1503+

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

Instructor: Mahla Shourian **Email:** mahla.shourian@ou.edu

Best way to reach me: **The best way to contact me and ask questions is before or after class.** I will always be around right after class, or in my office, so please come talk to me then. For other times, email me and we can set up a meeting — in person or online over Zoom.

Communications: Communications are handled primarily through Canvas and by email. Student emails are answered within 24–48 hours, unless prior notice of a delay is given. For a quicker response, please put the course prefix and number in the subject line (e.g., "ECON 2843: Question about the syllabus").

Email, Canvas & Connect: Students are expected to check their OU email and the Canvas course site regularly. Please make sure to:

- Set up your Connect account to access your homework and exams (a step-by-step guide is posted on Canvas).
- Set your default email address so you can reply directly from Canvas, and turn on your Canvas notifications.
- Update the Display Name in your Canvas profile so I know what you prefer to be called, and add a profile photo.
- It is recommended that you install the Canvas mobile app for on-the-go access to course materials, schedule, and communications.

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This is an introductory statistics course, which surveys basic statistical techniques with particular emphasis on business and economic applications. The learning objective of this course is to improve students' analytical skills in understanding and employing descriptive and inferential statistics. We begin by learning how to describe the data in use. We then focus on applied probability theory, which enables us to understand the essence of statistical inference. For the rest of the course, we explore multiple inference tools such as confidence-interval estimation, hypothesis testing, and the analysis of variance. These tools help us use sample data to reach conclusions about population parameters.

COURSE FORMAT & DELIVERY

This is an in-person course. We meet on Tuesdays and Thursdays from 4:30 to 5:45 p.m. in Cate Center One, Room 0237. I strongly encourage you to attend and actively participate in every session — engaging in real-time

discussion deepens your understanding and gives you the chance to ask questions and work through challenging concepts right away.

Homework, case studies, and exams are delivered through McGraw-Hill Connect, which links directly from Canvas and also provides your online homework, practice exams, and e-book. **All exams are taken in person during our class sessions on your own laptop** (see "Exams" below), so plan to bring a charged laptop on exam days.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Upon completion of this course, my goal is that you are able to:

- Understand and explain basic statistical concepts and the basic elements of real-world situations, and use that knowledge appropriately.
- Apply your understanding of statistics and economics to current events, and distinguish between correct and incorrect economic logic.
- Take away a long-lasting interest in economics, statistics, and the economy.

REQUIRED MATERIALS & SOFTWARE

Textbook: Business Statistics: Communicating with Numbers, 5th edition, by Jaggia and Kelly (ISBN 9781265988623), with McGraw-Hill Connect access.

Inclusive Access: This course uses Inclusive Access: unless you have opted out, you automatically have access to the textbook and Connect on the first day of class — there is nothing to purchase separately and no access code required. Information about opting out is provided by the OU bookstore at the start of the term.

Software & internet: You will need reliable internet access and **a laptop you can bring to class on exam days**. If you need help with Canvas, see the CAS Student Online Orientation. For Connect problems, contact McGraw-Hill support at <http://mhhe.com/support> or 1-800-331-5094 rather than contacting me.

GRADING POLICY

Points Breakdown

Component	Weight
Exams (1-4)	60%
Case Studies	20%
BookSmart Homework & Quizzes	20%
Total	100%

In-class exercises (extra credit): Attendance will not be taken, but throughout the semester we will do in-class exercises that carry extra credit. These points can be earned **only by being in class and completing the exercise**. Extra credit is added on top of the 100% above.

Grading Scale

Letter	Percentage
A	90% – 100%
B	80% – 89%
C	70% – 79%
D	60% – 69%
F	Below 60%

BookSmart Homework & Quizzes (20%)

You will have two types of online assignments in Connect: **BookSmart (LearnSmart)** and **Sample Test Questions**.

The BookSmart (LearnSmart) homework is the graded part and counts toward the 20%. It is an adaptive study plan: a built-in diagnostic gauges your strengths and weaknesses and builds an individualized plan tailored to you.

Staying current with it directly supports the 60% of your grade that comes from exams. At the end of the semester, your lowest BookSmart score is dropped.

Sample Test Questions are NOT graded — they are for practice only. They are designed to give you practice questions very similar to what you will see on the exams (generally about 10 questions with 3 attempts each). **I strongly encourage you to complete every one** — they are one of the best ways to prepare for the tests.

Do not wait until the last hours of the assignment window, and note that no late homework will earn points.

The system awards points only for work completed before midnight of the due date, and I do not adjust the system timeline once it is set. You may still complete past assignments for practice, but they will not earn points. All assignments are accessed through your McGraw-Hill Connect account.

Case Studies (20%)

You will have case studies completed through the Connect platform. **These are assignments that we will use Excel to use real world data to apply what we have learned in class to real world examples.**

We work on the case studies together as part of our lab sessions, as group activities in class. Because of this, **it is very important that you do not miss lab days** — being there is how you complete the work and earn full credit. The case studies count for **20% of your overall grade**, so missing a lab day can have a real impact on your grade.

Exams (60%)

You will have four exams (Exam 1–4) plus an optional final. **All four exams will be given IN PERSON in our normal classroom (Cate Center One, Room 0237).** Exams are taken on Connect on your own laptop during the class session, so **make sure your laptop is fully charged and ready to go on exam days.** **If you fail to bring a charged laptop, you will miss the exam.**

Each exam covers only the material from that section — **the exams are not cumulative:** Exam 1 (Ch 1–4), Exam 2 (Ch 6–7), Exam 3 (Ch 8–9), and Exam 4 (Ch 13–14). All exams are multiple-choice and graph/Excel-based. Exams account for 60% of your overall grade.

Optional Final Exam

An optional final exam is offered on the final-exam day (**Monday, December 14**). The optional final is 100% optional and covers material from Exams 1, 2, and 3. **If you take it and score higher than one of those three exams, it replaces the lower score;** if you score lower, it will not count against you and will not be added to the gradebook.

Missed Exams

Because exams are given in class on the scheduled day, plan to be present. If you know you will miss an exam, you must let me know **before the exam day** so we can work out a plan; otherwise the missed exam will be a 0 and you will need to use the optional final to replace it. According to university rules, approved reasons for a make-up are: active duty, pregnancy, university-approved events, jury duty, and religious observance. To be fair to all students, no grades will be adjusted on the basis of being "close."

EXAM SCHEDULE

A full week-by-week class calendar is posted on Canvas. Key exam dates are:

Exam	Date
Exam 1 — Chapters 1–4	Tue, Sep 22 (in class)
Exam 2 — Chapters 6–7	Thu, Oct 15 (in class)
Exam 3 — Chapters 8–9	Thu, Nov 12 (in class)
Exam 4 — Chapters 13–14	Thu, Dec 10 (in class)
Optional Final Exam	Mon, Dec 14 · 4:30–6:30 p.m.

Note: Dates are tentative and may be adjusted; the Canvas class calendar is the authoritative source. Please mark the exam dates on your personal calendar.

UNIVERSITY POLICIES

No Recording Policy in Class

Unauthorized audio/video recording is strictly prohibited in this course and its associated spaces. This policy protects all participants and respects intellectual property and FERPA rights. Violations, and any refusals to comply,

may result in disciplinary action through the Office of Student Conduct and/or removal from the classroom with an unexcused absence. Should you require recording accommodations, please register with the Accessibility and Disability Resource Center (ADRC) and obtain specific permission; authorized recordings will be made by the instructor and provided through an encrypted process.

Academic Integrity

The University of Oklahoma has a very strict protocol on academic integrity, and cheating is strictly prohibited. **All work (homework, exams, etc.) in this course should be your own.** Academic-integrity violations can result in an F for an assignment, an F for the course, and/or expulsion from the university. It is a very serious matter and will not be tolerated. For more information, please visit ou.edu/integrity.

AI Policy

This course assumes that all work submitted by students — process work, drafts, brainstorming artifacts, and final works — will be generated by the students themselves, working individually or in groups as directed by the assignment instructions. It is a violation of academic honesty to have another person or entity do any substantive portion of a graded assignment for you, including purchasing work, hiring a person or company to complete an assignment or exam, and/or using generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT).

Mental Health Support Services

Support is available for any student experiencing mental health issues that are impacting their academic success. Students can be seen at the University Counseling Center (UCC) on the second floor of Goddard Health Center, or receive 24/7/365 crisis support from a licensed provider through TELUS Health. To schedule an appointment or learn more, call the UCC at 405-325-2911. The UCC is located at 620 Elm Ave., Room 201, Norman, OK 73019.

Title IX Resources and Reporting Requirement

OU faculty are committed to a safe learning environment free from gender- and sex-based discrimination, including sexual harassment, domestic and dating violence, sexual assault, and stalking, in accordance with Title IX. Resources are available, including confidential support, medical attention, counseling, reporting, academic support, and safety plans. To speak with someone confidentially, contact OU Advocates (24/7 at 405-615-0013) or the University Counseling Center (M-F, 8–5, at 405-325-2911). Please note that faculty, Graduate Assistants, and Teaching Assistants are mandatory reporters and are obligated to report gender-based violence disclosed to us to the Institutional Equity Office (405-325-3546); after a report, the Title IX Coordinator will reach out with resources and support.

Reasonable Accommodation Policy (ADRC)

OU is committed to equal educational opportunity for students with disabilities. If you have already established accommodations with the Accessibility and Disability Resource Center (ADRC), please submit your semester accommodation request and contact me privately as soon as possible so we have adequate time to arrange them. If you have not yet established services but have a documented disability, complete the ADRC pre-registration form to begin. Contact the ADRC at (405) 325-3852, adrc@ou.edu, or www.ou.edu/adrc. Disabilities may include mental health, chronic health, physical, vision, hearing, learning and attention disabilities, and pregnancy-related and temporary medical conditions.

Religious Observance

It is the policy of the University to excuse absences that result from religious observances and to reschedule examinations and additional required classwork that may fall on religious holidays, without penalty. [See Faculty Handbook 3.15.2]

Adjustments for Pregnancy/Childbirth-Related Issues

Should you need modifications or adjustments because of documented pregnancy- or childbirth-related issues, please contact the Accessibility and Disability Resource Center at 405-325-3852 and/or the Institutional Equity Office at 405-325-3546 as soon as possible. See also the Institutional Equity Office FAQ on Pregnant and Parenting Students' Rights.

Final Exam Preparation Period

Pre-finals week is defined as the seven calendar days before the first day of finals. Faculty may cover new course material throughout this week. For specific provisions, refer to OU's Final Exam Preparation Period policy.

Emergency Protocol

Severe Weather: If you receive an OU Alert to seek refuge or hear a tornado siren, seek refuge inside a building — do not leave to find another building. Go to the building's severe-weather refuge location, or the lowest level possible in an innermost room away from outside doors and windows. Get in, get down, cover up, and wait for official notice to resume activities.

Active Threat (Run • Hide • Fight): OU embraces a Run, Hide, Fight strategy. RUN away from the threat if it is safe, and call 911 once safe. HIDE if running is not practical — lock and barricade doors, turn off lights, silence your phone, and stay quiet until law enforcement arrives. FIGHT only as a last resort if you cannot run or hide. Save OUPD in your phone — Norman non-emergency (405) 325-1717; emergency (405) 325-1911 or 911.

Fire Alarm / General Emergency: If the fire alarm activates or an OU Alert warns of danger, leave the building (do not use elevators), know at least two exits, assist those who need help, proceed to the emergency assembly area, notify first responders of anyone still inside, and wait for official notice before re-entering.

OU Food Pantry

College students often face food insecurity. The OU Food Pantry is open Tuesdays, Wednesdays, and Thursdays from 10 a.m.–6 p.m. at 333 Cate Center Drive, Norman, OK. All OU students are eligible and there is no paperwork — just bring your student ID. More information: <https://www.ou.edu/foodpantry>.

This syllabus and everything contained within are subject to change at the instructor's discretion.